regions. The idea is to promote family farm units on 'the fringes' of the soya export agribusiness chain.[16] However, this is rather small if we consider the whole dimension of the project (in particular if we consider the financial dimension). The region of Nacala is mostly composed of subsistence farmers (80%) involved in very traditional agriculture (*machamba*, in Mozambican Portuguese).

As will be clear, though, the analysis of all these projects and the understanding of their articulations and complex institutional architectures are constrained by the lack of official information in Mozambique. Information available is confused, fragmented and often contradictory. In the opinion of members of the National Union of Peasants (UNAC) of Mozambique, Brazilian involvement in agriculture and rural development encompasses a complex game of interests. They are far from being 'disinterested' or horizontal, as claimed in the official discourses of Brazil's South–South cooperation. The programmes of food security and support to family farming, promoted by the joint cooperation between the MDA and FAO, are very important to rural development and to those working on Mozambican lands. They cannot be seen separately from the large-scale agricultural projects run by Embrapa in cooperation with JICA and the Mozambican government. According to UNAC, cooperation programmes such as the Food Acquisition Programme (PAA) would be the 'good side of the cooperation' though much smaller than the other projects (which would embody the negative side of the cooperation) such as the ProSavana. The Brazilian cooperation evidences traces of a 'new colonialism' by transposing its experience, institutions and public policy instruments to Africa. [17]

The role of the state in conflicts involving Brazilian companies

Angola and Mozambique are two very different countries in spite of some common elements. They experienced Portuguese colonisation, late independence struggles, prolonged civil wars and attempts to build the state under a Soviet socialist model. Colonisation and armed conflicts have left significant marks at the economic, political, social and cultural levels in both countries.

At an economic level, the Portuguese influence is expressed in the still strong power of Portuguese groups and products in the economy,[18] particularly in Angola with the increasing role of the Angolan political elite in Portuguese companies (Santos 2013). At a political level, the ties are visible in a small number of social organisations which are not part of the government circle, and are in a difficult position, having informed popular participation in public decisions and because of the obstacles posed to those who have critical opinions about the government's actions. During the colonial regime, Portugal did not allow